



Settlement of New England Colonies

Plymouth and Massachusetts Bay
Religious Freedom and Colonial Foundations

Learning Objectives

- 1 Explain how the desire for religious freedom led to the settlement of the New England colonies.
- 2 Identify the significance of the Mayflower Compact in establishing self-governance.

 Source: Texts 2-4: Plymouth Colony, Overcoming Hardships, and Massachusetts Bay Colony





The Six Wives of Henry VIII



Catherine of Aragon
m. 1509 - 1533
Divorced



Anne Boleyn
m. 1533 - 1536
Executed



Jane Seymour
m. 1536 - 1537
Died



Anne of Cleves
m. 1540 Jan. - July
Divorced



Kathryn Howard
m. 1540 - 1542
Executed



Katherine Parr
m. 1543 - 1547
Widowed

Plymouth Colony: The Journey

Mayflower Voyage:



- More than 100 men, women, and children embarked on the difficult Atlantic crossing.



- Nov 1620, After a grueling journey, they landed at Cape Cod (present-day Massachusetts), exhausted and unable to continue to their intended Hudson River destination.



- They named their new settlement Plymouth after their departure port in England, establishing the first permanent European settlement in the region.



Sep 1620: Separatists and other English settlers secured a charter to establish a colony in northern Virginia, seeking religious autonomy and economic opportunity.



How did the desire for religious freedom lead to the settlement of the New England colonies?

Exploring the motivations behind colonial migration

Overcoming Hardships in Plymouth (1620–1621)

Settlement Challenges

- 📍 Built on abandoned Native village site; found stored corn but faced severe food shortages.

❄️ First Winter Ordeal

Harsh winter: insufficient food, too late to plant, inadequate shelters. Nearly half died from disease and starvation.

Leadership Change:

First governor died; William Bradford elected and led for 36 years.



Native American Assistance

Samoset - Introduced Pilgrims to Massasoit
Massasoit: Saved the Pilgrims

Massasoit - Established peaceful relations



Squanto - Taught planting corn/beans/pumpkins; showed eel catching



Successful Harvest

With Native help, Pilgrims achieved successful harvest, celebrated with thanksgiving day.

The Mayflower Compact

-  *Signed on November 11, 1620 by both Pilgrims and non-Pilgrims*
-  *Created a "civil body politic" to establish order and make laws for the colony's common good*
-  *Established tradition of self-government through elected representatives*
-  *Strengthened English tradition of governing through elected representatives rather than monarchy*

The Mayflower Compact was the first framework for self-government in colonial America, setting a precedent for democratic governance based on the consent of the governed.





What was the significance of the Mayflower Compact in colonial governance?

Understanding the foundation of self-government

Massachusetts Bay Colony

- 1 Puritan Beliefs: 1630s Puritans wanted to reform the Church of England, not separate from it. They opposed Catholic practices like ornate decorations and priest vestments.
- 2 Religious Conflict: King Charles I (1625) opposed Puritans, canceling business charters and jailing leaders.
- 3 Company Formation: 1629 Massachusetts Bay Company charter granted; John Winthrop became first governor, arriving 1630 with 1,000+ settlers.
- 4 Political Expansion: Initially only stockholders could vote; later expanded to male church members who elected representatives to the General Court.
- 5 Great Migration: 15,000 men, women, and children journeyed from England to Massachusetts Bay. Boston became the colony's largest town.



The Pilgrims & Puritans



Conclusion: Foundations and Legacy

Learning Objectives - Key Takeaways:

 **Religious Freedom:** Pilgrims sought worship autonomy, creating Plymouth as a refuge for their beliefs.

 **Self-Governance:** The Mayflower Compact established government by consent, a cornerstone of American democracy.

Colonial Legacy

These early settlements established a tradition of religious freedom, representative government, and community self-determination that would become fundamental to American identity.

